IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 03

WORK OR STUDY

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you work or are you a student?
- Why did you choose this job or subject?
- What do you like most about your work or studies?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a time you worked in a team.

You should say:

- what the task was
- who was in the team
- what each person did
- how you felt about the result

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Why is teamwork important in the workplace?
- Do you think some people work better alone?
- How is technology changing the way people work?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “work or study” card

A time you worked in a team

A job you would like to do in the future

A project you completed at work or school

A time you had to meet a deadline

A person you work or study with

A skill you learned for work or study

An achievement you are proud of

A time you helped a colleague or classmate

What the task was → **Who** was in the team → **What** each person did → **How** you felt about the result

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing your job or studies

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 juggle work and study

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ish va o‘qishni birga olib bormoq • *to manage two or more demanding activities at the same time*

BAND 8 STORY

Last year I had to **juggle work and study**, teaching English at a small centre in the evenings and attending lectures in the mornings. It was exhausting, but I learned to plan every hour, and my grades actually improved.

≈ **balance work and studies** — ish va o‘qishni muvozanatlamoq

≈ **combine a job with a degree** — ish va diplomni uyg‘unlashtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Juggle + A and B: bir vaqtda bir nechta ishni uddalash. Part 1 dagi ish va o‘qish savollarida juda tabiiy; ‘do both’ o‘rniga ishlating.

Namuna gap: Many students have to **juggle work and study** just to pay their tuition fees.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 a heavy workload

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘ir ish yuki • *a large amount of work that you have to do*

BAND 8 STORY

During exam season, I have **a heavy workload**: three essays, two presentations and a lab report in the same fortnight. I make a timetable on Sunday night, and ticking things off keeps me motivated.

≈ **a packed schedule** — to‘lib-toshgan jadval

≈ **a mountain of work** — tog‘dek ish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Have / cope with / be under a heavy workload. ‘Workload’ sanalmaydigan ot. Og‘ir ish yoki o‘qish haqida aytishda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Teachers often complain about **a heavy workload** and too much paperwork.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 be snowed under

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishga ko‘milib ketmoq • *to have so much work that you can hardly manage it*

BAND 8 STORY

This month I’m completely **snowed under** at work because two colleagues are on leave. I answer emails until midnight, and honestly I can’t wait for the weekend to catch up on sleep.

≈ **be swamped** — ishga ko‘milib ketmoq

≈ **be up to my eyes in work** — ish bilan to‘lib ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Be snowed under (with work). Norasmiy idioma; ‘very busy’ o‘rniga. ‘With’ bilan: snowed under with reports. Part 1 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: I’d love to help, but I’m **snowed under** with coursework at the moment.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 meet a tight deadline

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qisqa muddatga ishni yetkazmoq • *to finish work on time when there is very little time*

BAND 8 STORY

Our team had to **meet a tight deadline** for the client's report. We split the sections, worked late for three nights and handed it in with ten minutes to spare, and the pizza afterwards tasted like victory.

≈ **beat the deadline** — muddatdan oldin tugatmoq

≈ **work against the clock** — vaqt bilan poygalashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Meet / miss a deadline (kech qolsa: miss). Tight = siqiq. Ish va o'qishdagi stress haqida; Part 2 hikoyalarida juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: I find it hard to **meet a tight deadline** when I'm tired.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 put in long hours

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

uzoq soat ishlamoq • *to work for many hours*

BAND 8 STORY

My brother **puts in long hours** at the hospital, sometimes twelve a day. He comes home tired, but he says helping a patient recover makes the whole day worthwhile.

≈ **work overtime** — qo'shimcha ishlamoq

≈ **burn the midnight oil** — tunlari bilan ishlamoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(ariza) topshirmoq — I **put in** an application for the internship last week.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Put in + long hours / extra hours: ishda ko'p vaqt sarflashni ko'rsatadi. 'Work long hours' ham to'g'ri. Burn the midnight oil = kechgacha ishlamoq.

Namuna gap: Junior employees often **put in long hours** to impress their managers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 a steep learning curve

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tez va qiyin o'rganish davri • *a period when you have to learn many new things very quickly*

BAND 8 STORY

My first month as an intern was **a steep learning curve**. I had to learn the software, the company's rules and everyone's names at the same time, but by week four I was working without asking for help.

≈ **a baptism of fire** — qiyin sinov boshlanishi

≈ **a crash course in** — tezkor o'qitish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Have / face a steep learning curve: yangi ish yoki fanning qiyinligi. Aslida 'tez o'rganish' demakdir; Part 1 va 2 da yangi tajriba haqida.

Namuna gap: Moving to a new school involves **a steep learning curve**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 hands-on experience

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

amaliy tajriba • *practical experience gained by doing the work yourself*

BAND 8 STORY

My degree is mostly theory, so I took a summer job to get **hands-on experience**. Within two weeks I was solving real customers' problems, which taught me more than a whole semester of lectures.

≈ **practical experience** — amaliy tajriba

≈ **on-the-job training** — ish joyida o'qitish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Gain / get / offer hands-on experience. Sanalmaydigan ot. Nazariya va amaliyot farqi haqida Part 1 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: Internships give students **hands-on experience** that universities cannot provide.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 climb the career ladder

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

martaba zinapoyasidan ko'tarilmoq • *to move to better and higher positions at work*

BAND 8 STORY

My aunt started as a receptionist and gradually **climbed the career ladder** until she became a manager. She never missed a training course, and people say her determination is her real secret.

≈ **move up the ranks** — lavozimda ko'tarilmoq

≈ **get promoted** — lavozimi oshmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Climb / move up the career ladder. Kelajak rejalari va ambitsiya haqida Part 1 va 3 da. 'The' artikli bilan ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Women are increasingly able to **climb the career ladder** in many industries.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 a flexible schedule

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

moslashuvchan ish jadvali • *working hours that you can change to suit your life*

BAND 8 STORY

I chose this job because it offers **a flexible schedule**. I can attend my morning classes and then work from two to nine, which would be impossible in a normal nine-to-five office.

≈ **flexible hours** — moslashuvchan soatlar

≈ **flexitime** — moslashuvchan ish vaqti

Qachon ishlatiladi: Offer / have a flexible schedule. Ish tanlash sabablari yoki Part 3 dagi ish trendlarini tushuntirishda ishlating.

Namuna gap: A **flexible schedule** helps parents balance childcare and work.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 major in

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

mutaxassisligi ... bo‘lmoq • *to choose a main subject to study at university*

BAND 8 STORY

At university I decided to **major in** economics because I like understanding how money moves. Our lecturer used real examples from Uzbek businesses, and that made even difficult graphs feel interesting.

≈ **specialise in** — ...ga ixtisoslashmoq

≈ **study ... as my main subject** — ...ni asosiy fan sifatida o‘qimoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Major in + fan (amerika uslubi); ingliz tilida study / read. ‘I’m majoring in...’ deb ayting. Part 1 dagi ‘Why did you choose this subject?’ savolida.

Namuna gap: I’m planning to **major in** computer science and minor in design.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 follow in my parents' footsteps

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ota-onamning izidan bormoq • *to do the same job or life path as your parents*

BAND 8 STORY
I decided to **follow in my parents' footsteps** and become a teacher. Growing up, I watched them stay after school to help weaker students, and I wanted to feel that same pride.

≈ **take after my parents** — ota-onamga o'xshab ketmoq

≈ **go into the family business** — oilaviy biznesga kirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Follow in someone's footsteps: kasb tanlash sababini aytishda. 'Footsteps' ko'plik shaklida. Part 1 dagi 'Why did you choose this job?' savoliga.

Namuna gap: She **followed in her mother's footsteps** and became a doctor.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 spark my interest

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qiziqishimni uyg'otmoq • *to make you start to be interested in something*

BAND 8 STORY
A chemistry teacher in high school **sparked my interest** in science. She brought a small experiment to every lesson, and I stopped seeing the subject as boring formulas and started seeing it as magic.

≈ **ignite my passion for** — ...ga ishtiyoqimni alangalatmoq

≈ **awaken my curiosity** — qiziqishimni uyg'otmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Spark + interest / curiosity / debate. Ega: teacher, book, trip. O'tgan zamon: sparked. Part 1 va 2 da fanni tanlash sababini aytishda.

Namuna gap: A documentary about robots **sparked my interest** in engineering.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 be cut out for

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ga yaralgan, mos bo'lmoq • *to have the right qualities for a particular job*

BAND 8 STORY
At first, I wasn't sure I **was cut out for** teaching, because I get nervous in front of people. But after a few weeks, the children's smiles made the nerves disappear, and I realised I'd found my place.

≈ **be suited to** — ...ga mos bo'lmoq

≈ **have what it takes** — buning uchun kerakli sifatlarga ega bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Be cut out for + ot / -ing. Ko'pincha inkorda: I'm not cut out for sales. Norasmiy; kasbga moslik haqida gapirishda.

Namuna gap: I'm not **cut out for** office work; I need to be outdoors.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 play to my strengths

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kuchli tomonlarimdan foydalanmoq • *to do things that you are naturally good at*

BAND 8 STORY

I chose marketing because it lets me **play to my strengths**. I'm creative and I love talking to people, so writing campaigns feels easy for me, while spreadsheets always made me sleepy.

≈ **make the most of my skills** — ko'nikmalarimdan unumli foydalanmoq

≈ **use my talents** — qobiliyatlarimdan foydalanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Play to your strengths: kuchli tomoning bilan harakat qilish. 'Strengths' ko'plikda. Kasb tanlash va jamoadagi rol haqida.

Namuna gap: A good manager knows how to **play to** each person's **strengths**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 make a difference

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'zgarish qilmoq, farq yaratmoq • *to have a positive effect on people or a situation*

BAND 8 STORY

I want a career where I can **make a difference**. During a volunteer week at a children's hospital, I saw how a single kind nurse could change a scared child's whole day, and I knew I wanted that feeling at work.

≈ **have a positive impact** — ijobiy ta'sir ko'rsatmoq

≈ **change lives** — hayotlarni o'zgartirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Make a difference (to / in people's lives). Ish yoki ixtiyoriylik maqsadini tushuntirishda; 'different' emas, 'difference'. Part 1 va 2.

Namuna gap: Teachers can **make a difference** to a child's whole future.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 take pride in

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...dan faxrlanib, sifatli bajarmoq • *to feel proud of your work and do it carefully*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandfather **took great pride in** his carpentry. Even a simple chair had to be perfect, and I think that attitude, more than the money, is what made his work meaningful.

≈ **be proud of** — ...bilan faxrlanmoq

≈ **put my heart into** — jon-dilimni bag'ishlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Take pride in + ot / -ing: ishni sifatli bajarish. 'Pride' sanalmaydigan ot. Tabiiy ibora; Part 2 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: Employees who **take pride in** their work are usually more productive.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 a stepping stone

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

keyingi bosqichga olib boruvchi qadam • *something that helps you reach a better position later*

BAND 8 STORY

I see this part-time job as **a stepping stone** to a career in finance. The pay is small, but I'm learning how a real company works, and my manager has promised to write me a reference.

≈ **a springboard** — sakrash maydonchasi

≈ **the first rung of the ladder** — zinapoyaning birinchi pog'onasi

Qachon ishlatiladi: A stepping stone to / towards + maqsad. Hozirgi ish kelajakdagi martabaga yo'l ekanini aytishda. Part 1 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: An internship can be **a stepping stone** to a permanent job.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 a sense of fulfilment

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

qoniqish, maqsadga erishganlik hissi • *a feeling of happiness because you are doing something meaningful*

BAND 8 STORY

Teaching gives me **a sense of fulfilment** that no salary could replace. When a shy student finally spoke English in front of the class, I almost cried with pride, and that moment kept me going for weeks.

≈ **job satisfaction** — ishdan qoniqish

≈ **a feeling of accomplishment** — erishganlik hissi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Give / bring a sense of fulfilment. Fulfilment (ingliz) / fulfillment (amerika). Ishning ma'nosi haqida; Part 2 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: Volunteering gives many people **a sense of fulfilment**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 land a job

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishga kirib qolmoq • *to succeed in getting a job*

BAND 8 STORY

After sending forty applications, I finally **landed a job** at an IT company. I celebrated with plov at my uncle's house, and Monday morning felt like the first day of school again.

≈ **secure a position** — lavozimni qo'lga kiritmoq

≈ **get hired** — ishga olinmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Land a job / an interview / a contract: ko'p urinishdan keyin erishilgan natija. 'Find' dan kuchli, norasmiy-tabiiy. Part 1/2 da.

Namuna gap: Graduates with internship experience usually **land a job** faster.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 pursue a career in

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

...sohasida martaba qurmoq • *to follow a profession as your long-term work*

BAND 8 STORY

I'd like to **pursue a career in** medicine, even though the studying takes years. My grandmother's illness showed me how much patients depend on kind, careful doctors, and I want to be one of them.

≈ **build a career in** — ...sohasida martaba qurmoq

≈ **go into** — ...sohasiga kirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Pursue a career in + soha. Rasmiyroq: I'd like to pursue a career in law. 'Make a career' emas, 'pursue / build'. Kelajak rejalari, Part 1 va 3.

Namuna gap: Many young people want to **pursue a career in** technology.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Teamwork: working with others

21 pull together

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

birgalikda harakat qilmoq • *to work together to achieve a shared aim*

BAND 8 STORY

When our project almost failed, everyone decided to **pull together**. We shared the workload, stayed late and helped each other, and the atmosphere changed from stress to determination.

≈ **join forces** — kuchlarni birlashtirmoq

≈ **work as one** — bir yoqadan bosh chiqarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Pull together: qiyin vaziyatda jamoa birdamligini ko‘rsatadi. ‘Pull together to + fe’l’. Part 2 va 3 da jamoaviy ish haqida.

Namuna gap: In a crisis, good teams **pull together** instead of blaming each other.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 pull my weight

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘z ulushimni qo‘shmoq • *to do your fair share of the work*

BAND 8 STORY

In our group project, one member never replied to messages, so the rest of us had to cover for him. I learned that a team works well only when everyone **pulls their weight**.

≈ **do my fair share** — o‘z ulushimni qilmoq

≈ **carry my share of the load** — o‘z yukimni ko‘tarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Pull one’s weight: ish ulushini qilish; ko‘pincha inkorda: He doesn’t pull his weight. Jamoa ishining me’yorlari haqida.

Namuna gap: I always make sure I **pull my weight** when working with others.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 divide up the tasks

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

vazifalarni taqsimlamoq • *to share the jobs between team members*

BAND 8 STORY

At the first meeting, we **divided up the tasks** according to everyone’s skills. That simple decision saved us hours of arguments, because nobody had to guess what they should do next.

≈ **share out the workload** — ish yukini bo‘lib olmoq

≈ **delegate responsibilities** — mas’uliyatlarni topshirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Divide up / split up the tasks; assign tasks to someone. Jamoa ishining boshlanishini tasvirlashda Part 2 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: The first step is to **divide up the tasks** so everyone has a clear role.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 brainstorm ideas

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

g‘oyalar bo‘yicha miya hujumi o‘tkazmoq • *to produce many ideas quickly in a group before choosing the best*

BAND 8 STORY

We started by **brainstorming ideas** on a whiteboard for an hour. Some suggestions were silly and made us laugh, but one of them became the main concept of our final presentation.

≈ **come up with ideas** — g‘oyalar o‘ylab topmoq

≈ **throw ideas around** — g‘oyalarni o‘rtaga tashlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Brainstorm + ideas / solutions (to‘g‘ridan-to‘g‘ri fe’l). Birgalikda g‘oya yig‘ish uchun; yolg‘iz ham mumkin. Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: We usually **brainstorm ideas** before writing any report.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 take the lead

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yetakchilikni o‘z zimmasiga olmoq • *to be the person who guides the group*

BAND 8 STORY

Nobody wanted to **take the lead**, so the project drifted for a week. Finally Aziza said, ‘Let’s make a plan’, and from that moment we all felt calmer and more focused.

≈ **take charge of** — ...ni boshqarishni zimmasiga olmoq

≈ **step up** — oldinga chiqib, mas’uliyat olmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(raqobatda) oldinga chiqmoq — Our team **took the lead** in the second half.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Take the lead in + -ing / on a project. Jamoa ichidagi roli haqida; rahbarlik qobiliyatini ko‘rsatadi. Part 2 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: Someone has to **take the lead** when a team is confused.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 see eye to eye

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

fikri bir joydan chiqmoq • *to agree with someone*

BAND 8 STORY

At the beginning, my teammate and I did not **see eye to eye** about the design. We argued for ten minutes, then agreed to test both versions, and the result surprised us both.

≈ **be on the same page** — bir fikrda bo‘lmoq

≈ **share the same view** — bir xil qarashda bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: See eye to eye (with someone) on / about + masala. Ko‘pincha inkorda. Kelishmovchilikni yumshoq aytish usuli.

Namuna gap: My manager and I rarely **see eye to eye** on deadlines.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 bounce ideas off each other

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

g‘oyalarni bir-biri bilan sinab ko‘rmoq • *to share ideas with others to test and improve them*

BAND 8 STORY

I love working with Javlon because we **bounce ideas off each other** all the time. One of us proposes something half-baked, the other improves it, and by the end it’s much stronger than anything either of us could do alone.

≈ **share ideas** — g‘oyalar bilan o‘rtoqlashmoq

≈ **exchange views** — fikr almashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bounce ideas off + kishi. Norasmiy; hamkorlik afzalligini tushuntirishda juda yaxshi. Part 3 dagi jamoa va yolg‘iz ish savollarida.

Namuna gap: Working in a team allows you to **bounce ideas off** other people.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 rise to the challenge

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

sinovga munosib javob bermoq • *to deal successfully with a difficult situation*

BAND 8 STORY

When our leader fell ill the night before the presentation, we had to **rise to the challenge**. Each of us learned one extra section, and surprisingly the talk went more smoothly than any rehearsal.

≈ **step up to the plate** — mas’uliyatni zimmasiga olmoq

≈ **meet the challenge** — sinovdan o‘tmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rise to the challenge / occasion. Qiyin sharoitda jamoaning yaxshi harakati haqida; kuchli, ijobiy ibora. Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: Given a difficult task, the team **rose to the challenge** and delivered early.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 iron out differences

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kelishmovchiliklarni hal qilmoq • *to solve small disagreements by talking*

BAND 8 STORY

We managed to **iron out our differences** over a cup of tea after class. Once we had listened to each other’s concerns, the problem looked much smaller than it had during the argument.

≈ **settle a dispute** — nizoni hal qilmoq

≈ **sort things out** — masalani hal qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Iron out + differences / problems / details. Mayda kelishmovchiliklar uchun; katta janjal uchun emas. Part 2 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: Good communication helps colleagues **iron out differences** quickly.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 work hand in hand

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

qo‘l-qo‘lga berib ishlamoq • *to cooperate closely with someone*

BAND 8 STORY

The designers and programmers had to **work hand in hand** from the first day. Whenever one group made a change, the other adapted immediately, so we never had a nasty surprise at the end.

≈ **collaborate closely** — yaqin hamkorlik qilmoq

≈ **work side by side** — yonma-yon ishlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Work hand in hand with + kishi / bo‘lim. Yaqin hamkorlik, ijobiy ohang. Part 2 va 3 da jamoaviy ish haqida.

Namuna gap: Teachers and parents should **work hand in hand** to help children.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 a sense of achievement

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

erishgan yutuq hissi • *a proud feeling after you finish something difficult*

BAND 8 STORY
When we finally handed in the report, I felt **a sense of achievement**. We had stayed up until three the night before, and seeing the final document made every tired minute worthwhile.

≈ **a feeling of accomplishment** — erishgan yutuq hissi

≈ **a sense of pride** — faxrlanish hissi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Feel / get a (real) sense of achievement. Qiyin ishni tugatgandan keyingi his; Part 2 yakunida ishlating.
Namuna gap: Completing the marathon gave her **a sense of achievement**.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 over the moon

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xursandchilikdan boshi osmonga yetgan • *extremely happy about something*

BAND 8 STORY
When the results were announced and our team came second, I was **over the moon**. I called my mother straight away, and she cried more than I did, which made me laugh.

≈ **on cloud nine** — to‘qqizinchi osmonda

≈ **thrilled to bits** — juda xursand

Qachon ishlatiladi: Be over the moon (about / with something). Norasmiy, ingliz tili; ‘very happy‘ o‘rniga. Part 1 va 2 da.
Namuna gap: I was **over the moon** when I heard I‘d got the job.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 our hard work paid off

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

mehnatimiz o‘zini oqladi • *the effort we made gave a good result*

BAND 8 STORY
After weeks of rehearsals, **our hard work paid off**. The judges praised our clear structure, and one of them even asked for a copy of our slides.

≈ **our efforts bore fruit** — harakatlarimiz meva berdi

≈ **it was all worth it** — hammasi arziydi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hard work pays off / paid off. Pay off phrasal verb: mehnat natija berishi. Part 2 yakunida va Part 3 da muvaffaqiyat haqida.
Namuna gap: Studying every day finally **paid off** when I got Band 7 in reading.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 a weight off my shoulders

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

yelkamdan tog‘ ag‘darilgandek • *a feeling of relief when a worry or problem ends*

BAND 8 STORY

Submitting the thesis was **a weight off my shoulders**. For months I had thought about it every night, and that evening I slept for ten hours without any alarm.

≈ **a huge relief** — katta yengillik

≈ **a load off my mind** — ko‘nglim yengil tortdi

Qachon ishlatiladi: It was / felt like a weight off my shoulders. Qiyin ish tugagandagi yengillik haqida; Part 2 oxirida ishlating.

Namuna gap: Handing in the last assignment was **a weight off my shoulders**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 a confidence boost

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘ziga ishonchni oshiruvchi turtki • *something that makes you feel more sure of yourself*

BAND 8 STORY

Winning second place gave me **a confidence boost** I badly needed. I used to hide at the back in meetings, but now I raise my hand and share my opinion.

≈ **a morale booster** — ruhiyatni ko‘taruvchi narsa

≈ **a real lift** — haqiqiy ruhlanish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Give someone a confidence boost / be a confidence boost. ‘Boost’ = kuchaytiruvchi turtki (ot). Part 2 va 3 da ta’sir haqida.

Namuna gap: Positive feedback from a manager is a great **confidence boost**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 exceed expectations

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kutilganidan oshib tushmoq • *to be better than people thought it would be*

BAND 8 STORY

The final result **exceeded** everyone’s **expectations**, including ours. We had only hoped to pass, but our app was shown in front of the whole faculty, and my parents came to watch.

≈ **surpass expectations** — kutilganidan oshib ketmoq

≈ **go beyond what was expected** — kutilganidan ham ko‘pini qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Exceed / surpass / fall short of expectations (qarama-qarshisi). Natijani baholashda Band 8 fe’li; Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: Her first month on the job **exceeded** her manager’s **expectations**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 learn a valuable lesson

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qimmatli saboq olmoq • *to understand something important from an experience*

BAND 8 STORY

I **learned a valuable lesson** from that project: ask for help early. At first I tried to do everything alone and wasted three days, but the moment I spoke up, my teammates fixed it in an hour.

≈ **learn the hard way** — qiyin yo‘l bilan o‘rganmoq

≈ **take away an important message** — muhim xulosa chiqarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Learn a valuable lesson (from / about). ‘Do a lesson’ emas, ‘learn a lesson’. Hikoyaning xulosasi sifatida Part 2 da juda mos.

Namuna gap: Failing my first exam was painful, but I **learned a valuable lesson** about time management.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 build team spirit

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

jamoaviy ruhni mustahkamlamoq • *to create a feeling of friendship and loyalty in a group*

BAND 8 STORY

The trip to the mountains helped to **build team spirit** in our department. We cooked together, played football and, strangely, everyone communicated better when we returned to the office.

≈ **strengthen bonds** — aloqalarni mustahkamlamoq

≈ **foster camaraderie** — o‘rtoqlik ruhini rivojlantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Build / boost team spirit. Jamoaviy tadbirlarning ahamiyati haqida; Part 3 da kompaniya madaniyati mavzusida.

Namuna gap: Social events **build team spirit** and make colleagues more productive.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 go the extra mile

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

qo‘shimcha harakat qilmoq • *to make more effort than people expect*

BAND 8 STORY

Everyone in the team was willing to **go the extra mile**. Javlon even fixed bugs on his phone during his lunch break, and that attitude is what made us different from the other groups.

≈ **make an extra effort** — qo‘shimcha harakat qilmoq

≈ **do more than required** — talab qilingandan ko‘pini qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Go the extra mile (for someone / to do something). Mehnatsevarlikni ko‘rsatadigan Band 8 idiomasi; ko‘p mavzularda ishlatish mumkin.

Namuna gap: Good teachers **go the extra mile** to help struggling students.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 against all the odds

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

barcha qiyinchiliklarga qaramay • *even though success seemed very unlikely*

BAND 8 STORY

Against all the odds, we finished the prototype on time. Two members were ill, our laptop broke and the internet stopped, but we kept going, and I'll never forget the relief in the room.

≈ **in spite of everything** — hamma narsaga qaramay

≈ **beating the odds** — ehtimolni yengib

Qachon ishlatiladi: Against all (the) odds: ehtimoli past bo'lsa ham muvaffaqiyat. Gap boshida vergul bilan; 'odds' ko'plikda. Part 2 da dramatik hikoya.

Namuna gap: **Against all the odds**, our small company survived its first year.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: work trends and the future

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 work-life balance

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

ish va shaxsiy hayot muvozanati • *the right amount of time for work and for personal life*

BAND 8 STORY

Young people care more about **work-life balance** than my parents' generation did. My cousin refused a higher salary because the job required weekend work, and she said time with family is not for sale.

≈ **a healthy balance** — sog'lom muvozanat

≈ **quality time outside work** — ishdan tashqari sifatli vaqt

Qachon ishlatiladi: Achieve / maintain / strike a work-life balance. Part 3 dagi eng muhim ish mavzusi; sanalmaydigan ot. Salomatlik bilan bog'lab tushuntiring.

Namuna gap: Companies that respect **work-life balance** keep their best employees.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 work remotely

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

masofadan (uzoqdan) ishlamoq • *to do your job from home or another place, not the office*

BAND 8 STORY

Since the pandemic, many companies allow employees to **work remotely** two or three days a week. My sister saves two hours of commuting every day, though she says she sometimes misses chatting at the coffee machine.

≈ **work from home** — uydan ishlamoq

≈ **telecommute** — masofadan ishlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Work remotely / from home. Remote working (ot) ham ishlatiladi. Part 3 dagi texnologiya va ish savoliga to'g'ridan-to'g'ri mos.

Namuna gap: Technology makes it possible to **work remotely** from almost anywhere.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 job security

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ish joyining barqarorligi • *the feeling that you will not lose your job soon*

BAND 8 STORY

My father chose a government job because of **job security**. The salary isn't huge, but he never worried about being fired during hard years, and that peace of mind mattered to our family.

≈ **a stable job** — barqaror ish

≈ **a steady income** — doimiy daromad

Qachon ishlatiladi: Offer / provide job security. Sanalmaydigan ot. Ish tanlashdagi muhim omil sifatida; Part 3 da davlat va xususiy sektorni taqqoslashda.

Namuna gap: Many graduates prefer **job security** to a high but uncertain salary.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 a competitive job market

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

raqobat kuchli ish bozori • *a situation where many people try to get few jobs*

BAND 8 STORY

In **a competitive job market**, a degree alone is no longer enough. Employers ask for languages, internships and online certificates, so my friends spend evenings on courses rather than on entertainment.

≈ **a tough labour market** — qiyin mehnat bozori

≈ **fierce competition for jobs** — ishlar uchun qattiq raqobat

Qachon ishlatiladi: In / enter a competitive job market. Part 3 da yoshlar ishsizligi va ta'lim haqida; 'hard to find jobs' o'rniga yaxshi ibora.

Namuna gap: Graduates face **a competitive job market**, so practical skills matter.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 be replaced by automation

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

avtomatlashtirish tufayli o'rniga mashina kelmoq • *to lose a job because machines or software do the work*

BAND 8 STORY

Many routine jobs are likely to **be replaced by automation** in the next decade. My uncle works at a factory, and last year a robot arm took over the packing line, so he is now learning how to maintain it.

≈ **be made redundant by machines** — mashinalar tufayli ishsiz qolmoq

≈ **be taken over by robots** — robotlar egallab olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Be replaced by + ot (automation, AI, machines). Passiv shakl. Part 3 dagi 'How is technology changing work?' savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: Cashiers and drivers could **be replaced by automation** sooner than we think.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 upskill

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

malakani oshirmoq, yangi ko'nikmalar o'rganmoq • *to learn new skills so you can do your job better or find a new one*

BAND 8 STORY

To stay employed, many adults need to **upskill** regularly. My mother, a bookkeeper, took an evening course in data analysis, and now she handles reports that once took her colleagues a week.

≈ **retrain** — qayta o'qimoq

≈ **sharpen my skills** — ko'nikmalarimni charxlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Upskill (fe'l, ish dunyosi tili). Ot: upskilling. Texnologiya o'zgarishi va hayot davomida o'qish mavzusida Part 3 da.

Namuna gap: Workers should **upskill** in order to keep up with new technology.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 suffer from burnout

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kuyib ketishdan (charchoqdan) azob chekmoq • *to be completely exhausted because of too much stress at work*

BAND 8 STORY

My friend **suffered from burnout** after working seventy hours a week for a year. He lost interest in everything, even football, and only recovered when he took two months off and changed jobs.

≈ **be worn out** — charchab qolmoq

≈ **hit a wall** — kuchdan qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Suffer from / experience burnout. Sanalmaydigan ot; ish stressi va sog‘liq haqida Part 3 da. ‘Burn out’ fe’li ham mavjud.

Namuna gap: Long hours and high pressure make employees more likely to **suffer from burnout**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 earn a decent living

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

munosib daromad topmoq • *to get enough money from work to live comfortably*

BAND 8 STORY

All my father wanted was to **earn a decent living** for his family. He drove a taxi for twenty years, and thanks to that job we always had food, books and a roof over our heads.

≈ **make a good living** — yaxshi daromad qilmoq

≈ **make a comfortable living** — qulay yashashga yetarli topmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Earn / make a decent living. ‘Decent’ = munosib, qoniqarli. Part 3 da maosh va ish sifati haqida; ‘big salary’ o‘rniga ishlating.

Namuna gap: In some professions it is hard to **earn a decent living** at the start.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 lifelong learning

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

umr bo‘yi o‘rganish • *the idea that people continue to learn new things throughout their life*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandfather started learning English at sixty-five, which shows that **lifelong learning** has no age limit. He attends an evening class twice a week, and his enthusiasm puts many students to shame.

≈ **continuing education** — davomli ta’lim

≈ **self-improvement** — o‘z ustida ishlash

Qachon ishlatiladi: Promote / encourage lifelong learning. Sanalmaydigan ot. Ta’lim va kasb o‘zgarishi haqida Part 3 da; mavzuga oid rasmiy ibora.

Namuna gap: Employers should support **lifelong learning** by paying for courses.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 boost productivity

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

samaradorlikni oshirmoq • *to make people produce more work in the same time*

BAND 8 STORY

Our office introduced a shorter lunch break and quiet zones to **boost productivity**. At first, people complained, but after a month they admitted that they finished tasks faster and left on time.

≈ **increase efficiency** — samaradorlikni oshirmoq

≈ **improve output** — natijani yaxshilamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Boost / increase / improve productivity. Boost = kuchaytirmoq. Texnologiya va ish uslublari haqida Part 3 da.

Namuna gap: Collaboration tools can **boost productivity**, but only if people use them well.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 as long as / provided that + S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...bo'lsa (shart bilan) • *Sets a condition: something is true only if another thing happens*

BAND 8 STORY

I'm happy to work long hours **as long as** the work is meaningful. **Provided that** I can still see my family at weekends, I will gladly take on extra projects.

≈ **so long as** — ...bo'lsa

≈ **on condition that** — ...sharti bilan

Qachon ishlatiladi: As long as / provided that + hozirgi zamon (will emas): shartni bildiradi. 'If' dan kuchliroq: faqat shart bajarilsa. Part 1 va 3 da ishlating.

Namuna gap: People will accept a lower salary **as long as** they enjoy their job.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 It is essential that + S + (base verb)

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...muhimki, ... bo'lishi shart • *A formal pattern that says something is necessary*

BAND 8 STORY

It is essential that every team member **have** a clear role. Otherwise tasks overlap, people get frustrated, and the group wastes precious hours arguing instead of working.

≈ **It is important that + S + should...** — ...muhimki

≈ **It is vital for + N + to + V** — ...uchun hayotiy zarur

Qachon ishlatiladi: It is essential / vital / important that + ega + fe'lning oddiy shakli (have, be) yoki should + V; 'has' emas. Rasmiy uslub; Part 3 da fikr bildirishda.

Namuna gap: **It is crucial that** employees **be** given enough time to rest.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 Whether ... or ...

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

...bo'ladimi ... yoki ..., baribir • *Says that two options do not change the main point*

BAND 8 STORY

Whether you work in an office **or** at a kitchen table, discipline is what matters most. I discovered that when I started freelancing and had nobody to check my progress.

≈ **regardless of whether...** — ...ga qaramay

≈ **no matter whether ... or ...** — ...bo'lsa ham

Qachon ishlatiladi: Whether + A + or + B, asosiy gap: ikki variant ham natijani o'zgartirmasligini bildiradi. Part 3 da umumlashtirish uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Whether** you study alone **or** in a group, regular revision is the key.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 ..., which + V (comment on a whole clause)

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...bu esa ... • *Adds a comment about a whole idea after a comma*

BAND 8 STORY

Our team finished the app two days early, **which** surprised our lecturer and gave us time to practise the presentation. Looking back, that extra rehearsal probably won us the prize.

≈ **..., meaning that...** — ...ya'ni ...

≈ **..., a fact that...** — ...bu holat ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Vergul + which: butun gapga izoh. 'That' emas, 'which'. Part 2 da fikrni davom ettirish va ravon gapirish uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: I get up at five to study, **which** is hard but worth it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 Whereas / While + S + V, S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...bo'lsa, ... • *Contrasts two different facts in one sentence*

BAND 8 STORY

Whereas I plan everything early, my sister does her best work at the last minute. It drives me crazy, but I have to admit that she always gets great results.

≈ **On the other hand, ...** — Boshqa tomondan, ...

≈ **In contrast, ...** — Aksincha, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Whereas / while + gap, gap: ikki qarama-qarshi fikrni bir gapda. Vergul bilan ajrating. Part 3 da taqqoslash va 'some people... others' javoblarida.

Namuna gap: **While** remote work saves time, it can make people feel isolated.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 N, whose + N + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ning ...i ... bo'lgan • *Shows possession and adds information about a person or thing*

BAND 8 STORY

I have a manager **whose** patience is legendary. Last year a client shouted at her for ten minutes, and she just smiled, thanked him and solved the problem, which taught me more than any training course.

≈ **N, who has...** — ...ga ega bo'lgan

≈ **the person with + N** — ...ga ega kishi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Whose + ot: egalikni bildiradi (kishi, narsa). 'Who's' (who is) bilan adashtirmang. Shaxsni tasvirlashda Part 2 da foydali.

Namuna gap: I work with a colleague **whose** ideas always save us time.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 By the time + S + V(past), S + had + p.p.

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...paytga kelib ... bo'lgan edi • *Shows that one action was finished before a later point in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

By the time the deadline arrived, we **had rehearsed** the presentation five times. We were so well prepared that, when the projector failed, we simply carried on speaking without slides.

≈ **When + S + V(past), S + had + p.p.** — ...paytda ... bo'lgan edi

≈ **Before + S + V, S + had + p.p.** — ...dan oldin ... bo'lgan edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: By the time + o'tgan oddiy, + past perfect (had + p.p.): ma'lum payt oldidan tugallangan ishlar. Hikoyada ketma-ketlikni aniq ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **By the time** I got to the office, my colleagues **had** already **started** the meeting.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 I should have + p.p.

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...qilishim kerak edi • *Expresses regret about something you did not do in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

Looking back, **I should have asked** for help earlier. I wasted three days trying to fix the code alone, and that stubbornness cost the whole team valuable time.

≈ **I ought to have + p.p.** — ...qilishim lozim edi

≈ **If only I had + p.p.** — Kaski edi, ... qilsam

Qachon ishlatiladi: Should have + p.p.: o'tmishdagi afsus. 'Should of' deb yozmang! Part 2 da o'rganilgan saboq haqida gapirganda ishlating.

Namuna gap: **I should have prepared** more thoroughly before the interview.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 S + couldn't have + p.p. without + N

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...siz ... qila olmas edim • *Gives credit to someone who helped you*

BAND 8 STORY

We **couldn't have finished** the project **without** Javlon's coding skills. He stayed until midnight twice a week, and I'm convinced that his calm attitude kept the rest of us from panicking.

≈ **It wouldn't have been possible without...** — ...siz imkonsiz bo'lar edi

≈ **Thanks to + N, we managed to...** — ...tufayli ... uddaladik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Couldn't have + p.p. + without + ot: kimningdir yordamini qadrlash. Part 2 dagi minnatdorchilik va jamoaviy ish hikoyalarida.

Namuna gap: I **couldn't have passed** the exam **without** my teacher's support.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 Not wanting to + V, S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...xohlamay, ... • *A negative participle clause that gives a reason for an action*

BAND 8 STORY

Not wanting to let the team down, I stayed up all night to finish my part. It was exhausting, but the next morning everyone thanked me, and that tiny moment of recognition made it worth it.

≈ **Not knowing + wh-..., S + V** — ...bilmay, ...

≈ **Being + adj, S + V** — ...bo'lgani uchun, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Not + -ing (Not wanting / knowing / having + p.p.), asosiy gap: sababni qisqa ifodalaydi. Ega ikkala qismda bir xil bo'lishi kerak. Yozma va og'zaki Band 8.

Namuna gap: **Not knowing** where to begin, I made a list of everything I needed to do.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 It turned out that + clause

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Ma'lum bo'ldiki, ... • *Introduces a result that was different from what you expected*

BAND 8 STORY

At first I thought the job was boring, but **it turned out that** the work was far more interesting than I expected. By the end of my first week, I was staying late voluntarily, which surprised me.

≈ **As it happened, ...** — Aytganday, ...

≈ **It emerged that...** — Ma'lum bo'lib qoldiki...

Qachon ishlatiladi: It turned out that + gap / to be + ot: kutilmagan natijani aytish. Hikoyada burilish nuqtasi uchun juda foydali; Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: **It turned out that** my teammate had worked in the same field for years.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 Hardly had + S + p.p. when + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ishi bilanoq ... bo'ldi • *Shows that one thing happened immediately after another*

BAND 8 STORY

Hardly had I started my first shift **when** the manager asked me to lead a meeting. My heart was racing, but I took a deep breath and spoke slowly, and by the end I had stopped shaking.

≈ **Scarcely had... when...** — ...ishi bilanoq ...

≈ **No sooner had... than...** — ...ishi bilanoq ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hardly / Scarcely + had + ega + p.p. + when + o'tgan zamon ('than' emas). Rasmiy inversion; hikoyada tez ketma-ket voqea uchun.

Namuna gap: **Hardly had** the meeting begun **when** the power went out.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a time you worked in a team.

Describe a time you worked in a team.

You should say:

- what the task was
- who was in the team
- what each person did
- how you felt about the result

My 1-minute notes

- university project • app for campus contest • three weeks
- five of us • Aziza leader • Javlon coder
- me: user research + slides • two did design, testing
- disagreed on colours • voted • ironed out
- second out of twenty • over the moon • sense of achievement
- valuable lesson • pull together • confidence boost

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (the task)	I'd like to tell you about a time I worked in a team at university. In my second year, our course leader asked us to build a small mobile app for a campus competition, and we had only three weeks to meet a tight deadline.
P • Who was in the team	There were five of us, all from the same year. Aziza, the most organised, took the lead and divided up the tasks, Javlon was a brilliant coder, and two classmates handled design and testing. I was in charge of user research and the presentation slides.
P • What each person did	Because we divided up the work from day one, everyone could play to their strengths. We didn't always see eye to eye, especially about the colours, but we ironed out our differences by voting. By the time the deadline arrived, we had rehearsed the presentation five times.
E • Reason 1	As for how I felt, I was over the moon when we came second out of twenty teams. It exceeded all our expectations, and it gave me a huge sense of achievement after so many late nights.
E • Reason 2	On top of that, it taught me a valuable lesson. I couldn't have finished even half of it without my teammates, and I realised that pulling together is far more effective than working alone.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, it was a demanding project, but it was also a real confidence boost, and it's the reason I now actively look for group work.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
I have a lot of work	I'm snowed under / I have a heavy workload
I work many hours	I put in long hours
a difficult job	a demanding job with a steep learning curve
we worked well together	we pulled together
I did my share	I pulled my weight
we had different opinions	we didn't see eye to eye
I was very happy with the result	I was over the moon with the result
a lot of work	a heavy workload
finish on time	meet a tight deadline
learn by doing	hands-on experience
get a better position	climb the career ladder
choose my own hours	a flexible schedule
my main subject was	I majored in
it made me interested	it sparked my interest
I'm not suited to it	I'm not cut out for it
use what I'm good at	play to my strengths
get a job	land a job
give the work to each person	divide up the tasks
share ideas	brainstorm ideas
lead the group	take the lead
I felt relieved	it was a weight off my shoulders
it made me confident	it was a confidence boost
do better than expected	exceed expectations
work from home	work remotely
a safe job	job security